Joseph Heffernan

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linkedin.com/in/joseph-heffernan-676965269 · github.com/Joeysdi · linksgone.com (the product I built, live)

Australian citizen · Relocating to Australia, September 2026 — Sydney, Melbourne or Brisbane, flexible · Available immediately (remote), onsite from arrival · No visa sponsorship required

PROFILE

Founder and self-taught full-stack engineer, raised in a family financial-markets business. In 2026 I designed, built, and ran an AI-likeness protection platform as its only engineer, covering the product, the takedown operations, the legal work, and the customers: helping victims of impersonation, deepfakes, and image-based abuse get harmful content removed. Earlier: market analysis, M&A support, and capital raising in the family's financial-markets firms, where I worked from school age. I ship fast, learn faster, and I'm at my best owning a problem end-to-end.

EXPERIENCE

Founder & CEO — LinksGone (Unimpersonationable, LLC)

Feb 2026 – Aug 2026

AI-likeness protection SaaS (Wyoming LLC, operated from Bangkok) — sole engineer and operator; wound down day-to-day operations Aug 2026 ahead of relocation, platform remains live

- Designed, built, and operated the entire production platform solo, from first commit to **verified content removals for victims of image-based abuse**, shipping daily for six months (**2,800+ commits**, 1,300+ TypeScript files, 125 database migrations, 127 automated test files), with AI-agent tooling as a force multiplier.
- Investigated, triaged by harm type and urgency, and resolved abuse complaints end-to-end — intake, evidence preservation, correct legal basis, platform and regulator escalation, confirmed removal — including **non-consensual intimate imagery and voice-clone cases**, and earned adoption from leadership of national creative-industry organisations through a 100+ organisation outreach campaign.
- Built an automated takedown-routing engine covering **1,176 verified reporting routes** across global platforms and national regulators, including **Australia's eSafety Commissioner reporting schemes under the Online Safety Act 2021**, guarded by an audit suite that maintained zero misroutes in production.
- Engineered a Playwright-based legal form-submission system with **26 platform-specific DMCA/identity submitters** (YouTube, Instagram, TikTok, X, Cloudflare, GitHub, and others), with captcha handling and three-verdict confirmation so no filing is ever falsely reported as sent.
- Shipped platform-grade trust-and-safety governance: weekly public transparency reports, a bad-faith-filing tripwire flagging stale takedowns for human review, and DMCA counter-notice-window tracking.
- Enforced "your photo never leaves your device" as an executable contract: client-side in-browser ONNX face embeddings, plus a network-interception audit that fails the build if raw image bytes ever appear in outbound traffic.
- Lifted face-search benchmark recall from **28% to 93%** via vector-embedding pipeline work (InsightFace / glint360k).
- Hardened a biometric-data platform across 318 security-tagged commits: 49 Postgres row-level-security policies, dependency vulnerabilities cut from 47 to 3, locked security headers, and a published vulnerability-disclosure program (RFC 9116).
- Shipped a cross-browser extension (Chrome MV3 + Firefox) fanning searches across 9 reverse-image engines from users' own browsers, with real-time result streaming. *Code tour and product walkthrough available on request.*

Associate, M&A & Business Development — Knightsbridge Group / KXCO Nov 2020 – Jul 2023

Family investment and fintech group, Bangkok (initially remote alongside UK studies)

- Originated the client introduction and supported closing of KXCO's **Dubai real-estate tokenization mandate** with Arthur Mackenzy Group: tokenization of the 25-villa Paradise Hills development (launched May 2023) and a second digital asset for a Downtown Jebel Ali luxury-hotel project, both publicly announced.
- Supported completion of a **US$3M** M&A transaction between two technology companies, coordinating legal and financial workstreams through closing.
- Built and executed a sales strategy targeting high-net-worth individuals and family offices, contributing to a 20% revenue increase.
- Advised MetaStock, a major client, on media-partnership expansion; produced market research and tailored outreach materials.

Founder — Wingfield Capital Limited Jul 2021 – Jan 2023

UK investment vehicle (Companies House no. 13512226) — active operations Jul–Dec 2021; wound down voluntarily and dissolved Jan 2023 with investor capital returned

- Raised **US$779k** in three months: identified target investors, built the pitch deck and full financial model, negotiated and closed.

Market Analyst & Writer — LiveTradingNews 2014 – present · part-time

Family financial-media business, remote — contributing from age 12 alongside school and other roles

- Grew up inside the markets: financial analysis and valuation modelling, research and market commentary published under a public byline (available on request), working with Bloomberg, Excel, and senior analysts from an early age.

Freelance ESL Educator & Independent Trader — Bangkok 2023 – 2026

- Ran English-language camps for groups of 30–300 Thai students while trading independently: public speaking, curriculum delivery, and working in a second-language environment.

EDUCATION

Undergraduate studies, BSc (Hons) Economics — University of Buckingham, UK 2020 – 2022

Preliminary and Part I examinations completed (economics, quantitative methods, accounting, statistics)

SKILLS

Engineering: TypeScript · React / Next.js · Node.js · Python · PostgreSQL / Supabase · vector search & embeddings · browser extensions (Chrome MV3) · Playwright automation · Git / CI · Vercel · LLM & AI-agent tooling

Trust & safety / online safety: abuse-report investigation & evidence handling · content takedowns (DMCA §512, impersonation, NCII frameworks) · fraud & impersonation-scam investigation · platform & regulatory reporting, escalation · OSINT & image provenance · privacy-first data handling

Finance: financial modelling & valuation · M&A transaction support · capital raising · trading (technical & fundamental) · accounting · Bloomberg

Commercial: sales & business development · stakeholder communication · SEO / growth · copywriting · public speaking

References available on request.